called a meeting of the envoys from neighbouring countries within a month of the announcement of the initiative to provide some flesh and blood to the underlying sentiment and shape the initiative as a policy. Besides SAARC countries, Indian envoys from China, Iran, the Central Asian Republics, and Myanmar attended this meeting.[2] Foreign Minister Sushma Swaraj announced at this meeting that a "3C mantra" of "Commerce, Culture and Connectivity" will be followed in relation to the neighbouring countries as also the world. Six months later, while addressing the SAARC Summit in Kathmandu in November 2014, Modi shared some of his thoughts on the neighbouring region. He said:

> the future I dream for India is the future I wish for our entire region. … For India our vision of the region rests on five pillars – trade, investment, assistance, cooperation in every area, contacts between our people – and all through seamless connectivity.[3]

The Prime Minister's initiative was subsequently given greater policy content by Foreign Secretary S. Jaishankar. Initially, while asserting that "The word 'neighbourhood first' has a clear self-explanatory message," Jaishankar echoed the Prime Minister's message: "A neighbourhood first policy that puts premium on connectivity, contacts and cooperation. Where required, one that *is both reasonable and firm*."[4] A few months later, some of the key components of this policy were spelt out a bit more clearly, when he said:

> The term is meant to convey a *strong sense of priority, not suggest a problem-free future*. … It is posited on the belief that whatever our past, the realization of shared prosperity can be our goal. To achieve that we will not only have to sharply raise levels of cooperation and connectivity, but also *bring to bear a new mind set*. Where India is concerned, *it could itself drive regional cooperation rather than be driven by it*. In fact, *we should be pursuing our own goals purposefully, without letting them be overly*